

BOASIS PORTAL

Onboarding, free zones

Every screen, field, rule, branch, message, reminder and consequence of the onboarding, written so the developer can build it and anyone can understand it.

Version 2 · 28 September 2026 · Status: agreed scope, two decisions open (section 12)
Source of truth for screens, data and rules. Replaces the v1 draft.

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1. The product in one page

The Boasis Portal is a self-service tool for founders and freelancers who run 1 to 3 free zone companies in the UAE. It does four things:

Function	What it means
Know	Holds one company file: the licence, owners and managers, office, cards, tax details. Uses it to work out everything that applies.
Tell	Every date, rule and step that applies to this company, in time, by email, to the right person.
Guide	Plain explanations and step-by-step instructions for each requirement, specific to the company's free zone.
Keep	Stores every document with its dates, so it is ready when the bank, auditor, agent or zone asks.

ONE PATTERN FOR EVERY REQUIREMENT

Knowledge (what it is and why it matters) → Choice (what do you want to do) → Steps (exactly what to do, who does it) → Evidence (proof it is done).

THREE HARD LIMITS

- The portal **never submits** anything to government or a zone. The user or their agent does.
- The portal **never shows or calculates fine amounts**. Consequences are explained in words with the official source.
- The portal **never guesses**. If a rule has no source, it says "unknown" and who can answer.

2. Decisions this document rests on

#	Decision	Status
1	Portal = Know, Tell, Guide, Keep	CEO, agreed
2	First users: founders and freelancers with 1 to 3 licences	CEO, agreed
3	Free zones first. Mainland shows "coming soon" with a waitlist; the data model carries mainland from day one	CEO, agreed
4	Pricing: 1 company AED 30 a month; up to 3 companies AED 90 a month	CEO, agreed
5	A full account is created first, then onboarding starts	CEO, agreed
6	Reminders by email only. No WhatsApp	CEO, agreed
7	Ask "who handles your zone paperwork" (agent or partner)	CEO, agreed
8	Every requirement follows: knowledge, choice, steps, evidence	CEO, agreed
9	The portal never submits to government	CEO, agreed
10	Consequences in words with source; no fine amounts anywhere	CEO, agreed
11	Deferred: employee contracts, WPS, salary, nationality, Emiratisation, integrations, document scanner	CEO, agreed
12	In scope: visas and visa quota for owners, managers and employees	CEO, agreed
13	Tax numbers are asked, optional, with the reason shown	CEO, agreed
14	Renew, cancel and amend are full workflows, built after onboarding	CEO, agreed
15	Which free zones get deep content first	CEO to choose
16	When the subscription is charged	Open (section 12)

3. How every screen behaves

1. **One topic per screen.** A title, one "why we ask" line, the fields, then Continue.
2. **Nothing blocks.** Every step has "I'll add this later". A skipped item becomes *skipped* and creates a task "Complete: <item>" on the company.
3. **"Not sure" is always an answer** where the user may not know. It stores *unknown* and creates a task with who can answer it.
4. **Progress saves after every step.** Leaving and returning resumes on the same step, on any device.
5. **Live dates.** A side panel "Your dates so far" fills in as answers arrive. On a phone it is a collapsible bar at the bottom.
6. **Every value records where it came from.** Stored values are user-entered (U), or read from a document (D, reserved for the scanner later, always confirmed by a person). Each has a state: known, unknown or skipped, and the date entered. Calculated (C) and rule-based (R) results are never stored; the rules engine recomputes them.

7. **Every rule shown carries its source and grade** (confirmed or reported). No source means "unknown" plus who can tell you (the zone, your agent, your accountant, the FTA).
8. **Dates** use day, month, year pickers. An expiry before its issue date is refused: *"The expiry date must be after the issue date."* A date more than 10 years away asks *"Is this right?"*
9. **Uploads** are allowed on every step: PDF, JPG, PNG, up to 20 MB. They go to the vault only; the user still types the fields (no scanner in v1).
10. **Works** in light and dark, on phone and desktop.

Field states the developer must support

State	Meaning	What the user sees
known	A value was given	The value and anything computed from it
unknown	User chose "Not sure"	"We still need this" with who can answer; a task
skipped	User chose "I'll add this later"	"Add later" reminder in the weekly digest; a task

4. The flow at a glance



Account (0)

└─ Add a company (1)

└─ Mainland → "Coming soon" + waitlist

(can add a free zone company instead)

└─ Already on Boasis → "Ask its owner to invite you"

(same zone + licence number, no duplicate)

└─ Free zone → 2 → 3 → 4 → 5 → 6 → 7 → Your year (8)

└─ Employees (9, optional)

Any step: "I'll add this later" = skipped + task

"Not sure" = unknown + task

Progress saved after every step

TIME TO COMPLETE

Target: under 10 minutes for a solo founder with the licence, passport and visa at hand. Every step can be finished later.

5. Step by step

Step 0. Create your account

WHY LINE

"Your account keeps your company file private to you and the people you invite."

Field	Required	Rules and validation	Why we ask (shown to the user)
Full name	yes	Text, 2 to 100 characters	Your name on the account
Email	yes	Valid email; must be verified by link before step 1 opens	Sign-in and all reminders go here
Password	yes	At least 12 characters; refused if found in known leaked-password lists	Protects your company file
Two-step sign-in	offered	Authenticator app; can be turned on later in settings	Extra protection for your documents
Plan	yes	1 company, AED 30 a month; up to 3 companies, AED 90 a month	Sets how many companies you can add
Terms and privacy	yes	Tick box, stores version and date accepted	Required

OPEN

When the plan is charged (at sign-up or at step 8) is open decision 1, section 12.

Step 1. Add a company

SCREEN TITLE AND WHY LINE

"Where is your company licensed?" · "This decides which rules and steps apply to you."

Field	Required	Rules and validation	Why we ask (shown to the user)
Jurisdiction	yes	Free zone, or Mainland	Rules differ by authority
Free zone	yes	Search list of the 42 zones (content/authorities/index.json)	Loads the zone's rules
Your role in this company	yes	Owner, Manager, Adviser (accountant, PRO, agent)	Who you are to this company

Branches

Situation	What happens
Mainland chosen	Screen <i>"Mainland is coming soon. We will email you when it opens."</i> Collect emirate and consent to email. Save a waitlist entry. Button: <i>"Add a free zone company instead"</i> .
Adviser	Allowed. Company is created under this account. The owner can be invited later (invites are part of access, not onboarding).
Plan limit reached	On the 1-company plan with 1 company already: <i>"Your plan covers 1 company. Upgrade to up to 3 companies for AED 90 a month."</i>
Company already on Boasis	Checked at step 2 (same zone and licence number): <i>"This company is already on Boasis. Ask its owner to invite you."</i> No duplicate is created. Do not reveal who owns it.

Step 2. Your company

SCREEN TITLE

"Your licence"

Field	Required	Rules and validation	Why we ask (shown to the user)
Company name	yes	As printed on the licence	Your company file
Licence number	yes	Text; unique per zone across Boasis	Your company file; stops duplicates
Legal form	yes	FZE, FZCO, FZ-LLC, Branch, Other, Not sure	Some requirements depend on it
Licence status	yes	Active, Expired, Renewal in progress, Being cancelled	So we start from where you really are
Licence issue date	yes or skip	Date	Renewal dates
Licence expiry date	yes or skip	Date; must be after issue date	Renewal dates and reminders
Licence term	default 1 year	1, 2, 3 years or more	Some zones issue multi-year licences
Date of incorporation	skip allowed	Date; not after today	"On your Certificate of Incorporation or Registration, not your licence. After a renewal the licence issue date changes; this date never does." Needed for the corporate tax deadline
Activities	skip allowed	List of text entries	Some activities need approvals later
Website	optional	URL	Company file

Who handles your zone paperwork?	yes	Me; An agent or partner (name, email optional); The zone directly; Not sure	Every step later says "you do this" or "send this to your agent"
Licence file	optional	Upload	Kept in your vault
Certificate of incorporation	optional	Upload	Kept in your vault

WHY THE AGENT QUESTION MATTERS

Some zones only accept applications through registered partners: IFZA says licensees apply through IFZA-registered partners on its Partner Portal and have no direct login confirmed (ifza.json, submissionChannel). Steps must then read "send this to your agent".

What this step computes (shown live)

- Licence renewal date = expiry date.
- Licence reminders at 90, 60, 30, 14, 7 and 1 days before expiry (Boasis schedule, same for every zone).
- Decision point at 90 days before expiry: *"Renew, cancel or change?"* This opens the renewal, cancellation or amendment workflow (built after onboarding).
- The zone's own renewal facts, each with source and grade (Appendix A): whether the lease must be valid to renew, what renews together, and what happens after expiry.

Licence status branches

Status	What happens	Consequence shown
Active	Normal flow.	None.
Expired	Screen <i>"Your licence expired N days ago."</i> Shows, in words, what the zone says happens next, with source and grade (Appendix A). Button "Start renewal now" opens the renewal workflow once built; until then, the zone's renewal checklist and contact. Onboarding continues.	From Appendix A for the chosen zone. If the zone is unknown: <i>"We do not have this zone's rules on late renewal yet. Contact the zone or your agent today."</i>
Renewal in progress	Ask "Expected new expiry date" (optional). Reminders restart from the new date once entered.	None.
Being cancelled	Onboarding continues. Company is flagged "being cancelled". Cancellation workflow offered once built.	Cancellation duties (tax deregistration and others) belong to that workflow.

Step 3. People

SCREEN TITLE AND WHY LINE

"Owners and managers" · "Their passports, visas and Emirates IDs have dates we will watch for you."

Field	Required	Rules and validation	Why we ask (shown to the user)
Full name	yes	Text. The account holder is prefilled as the first person	Company file

Email	optional	Valid email	To invite them later
Role in this company	yes	Shareholder, Manager, Both	Who owns and who signs
Ownership %	if shareholder	0 to 100; total across shareholders must not pass 100	Ownership records (UBO)
Passport expiry	skip allowed	Date	"A passport needs at least 6 months left to renew a UAE residence visa."
Residence visa: who sponsors it?	yes	This company; Another of my companies (pick one); Family; Another employer; Not a UAE resident	Only visas under this company use its quota
Residence visa expiry	if resident	Date	Visa reminders
Emirates ID expiry	if resident	Date	Emirates ID reminders
Passport, visa, Emirates ID files	optional	Uploads	Kept in the vault

Rules

- Only sponsor = "This company" takes a place in this company's visa quota (step 5 is prefilled from it).
- Passport, visa and Emirates ID belong to the **person**, not the company. A person on two companies has one set of personal dates. Role and ownership % belong to the person *in that company*.
- When adding a second or third company, people already on the account are offered first. Picking one reuses their personal documents; it never copies role, ownership or visa sponsor.
- If sponsor = "Another of my companies" but that company is not on Boasis yet: store the sponsor as "another company" and offer "Add that company next".

What this step computes

- Passport: early warning at 9 months left, alert at 6 months left (federal rule, ICP confirmed).
- Visa and Emirates ID: reminders 90, 60, 30, 14, 7, 1 days before expiry.
- If the visa sponsor is this company, the visa renewal becomes a requirement of this company.

Step 4. Office

SCREEN TITLE AND WHY LINE

"Your office" · "Most zones need a valid office or desk contract to renew your licence."

Field	Required	Rules and validation	Why we ask (shown to the user)
Office type	yes	Flexi desk or business centre; Office; Warehouse or land; None; Not sure	The office decides what the zone asks at renewal
Contract or lease end date	skip allowed	Date	Lease reminders, timed before the licence
Renews with the licence?	optional	Yes, No, Not sure	Some zones renew both in one request

Contract file	optional	Upload	Kept in the vault
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What this step computes

- Lease reminders at 90, 60 and 30 days before the lease end, always shown before the licence reminder.
- If the lease ends before the licence expiry: *"Your lease ends before your licence. <Zone> requires a valid lease to renew your licence."* Only for zones where this is confirmed (Appendix A). Other zones: *"Your lease ends before your licence. Check with your zone whether it must be renewed first."*
- DMCC Business Centre only: *"Renew your lease if it has under 90 days left. DMCC lets you renew it in the same request as your licence."* confirmed

Step 5. Establishment card and visa quota

SCREEN TITLE AND WHY LINE

"Visas your company can sponsor" · "Your establishment card and quota decide whether you can issue or renew visas."

Field	Required	Rules and validation	Why we ask (shown to the user)
Establishment (immigration) card expiry	skip allowed	Date	Needed to issue or renew visas
Visa quota allowed	skip allowed	Number. Prefilled from zone and office type where confirmed; editable	How many visas the company may sponsor
Visas used now	skip allowed	Number. Prefilled with owners and managers sponsored by this company; user adds employees	Visas left
Card file	optional	Upload	Kept in the vault

Prefill values (confirmed only)

Zone	Office type	Visas allowed	Grade
RAKEZ	Flexi desk	1	confirmed
DMCC	Flexi desk	up to 3	confirmed
All others	any	empty, user enters	unknown

What this step computes

- Card reminders 90, 60, 30, 14, 7, 1 days before expiry.
- Visas left = allowed minus used.
- If used is more than allowed: *"Your records show more visas than your quota allows. Check with your zone."*
- Card expired or expiring: *"While your establishment card is expired you cannot issue or renew visas."*
Confirmed for Ajman Free Zone (afz.gov.ae); for other zones: *"Most zones need a valid establishment card for visa services. Check with your zone."*

Step 6. Corporate tax

SCREEN TITLE

"Corporate tax" · Question 1: "Is the company registered for corporate tax?" Yes, No, Not sure.

If Yes

Field	Required	Rules and validation	Why we ask (shown to the user)
Tax registration number (TRN)	optional	15 digits	"So it is in one place when your bank, accountant or invoices ask for it."
End date of the first tax period	skip allowed	Date	"It is on your registration certificate. A first period can run 6 to 18 months, so your financial year end alone cannot tell us your first return date."
Financial year end	yes or skip	Day and month	Every return after the first
Will you claim Qualifying Free Zone Person status?	yes	Yes, No, Not sure	"It decides whether your accounts must be audited."

- Return and payment due **9 months after each tax period ends** (FTA [confirmed](#)). First return from the first period end; later returns from the financial year end.
- A new company's first tax period can run 6 to 18 months (FTA Public Clarification CTP003 [confirmed](#)).
- If QFZP = Yes: audited financial statements are required (Ministerial Decision 84 of 2025 [confirmed](#)). The audit due date shows as unknown until sourced.

If No: the deadline rule

Is the date of incorporation known?

└ No → "We need your date of incorporation to tell you your deadline." (link back to step 2)

└ Yes → Incorporated on or after 1 March 2024 AND less than 3 months ago?

└ Yes → "Register by <incorporation date + 3 months>."
| Guide: how to register on EmaraTax. Reminders 30, 14, 7, 1 days before.

└ No → "You are late to register for corporate tax."
Consequence in words (section 8). Guide: register now.
Waiver message (see below).

Then ask the financial year end, so the first return date can be shown.

- Companies incorporated on or after 1 March 2024: register within 3 months of incorporation (FTA Decision 3 of 2024 [confirmed](#)).
- Companies incorporated before 1 March 2024: their registration deadlines, set by licence issue month, all fell in 2024. Not registered now means late. No per-month table is needed.

WAIVER MESSAGE, GATED

Final text, shown only after the FTA page is rechecked before launch: *"If you register and file your first return within 7 months of the end of your first tax period, the late registration penalty can be waived."* (FTA waiver page, FTA news 14 May 2026). Its status in September 2026 is unverified.

Until rechecked: *"The FTA has offered a waiver for late registration. Check its current status on tax.gov.ae."*

If Not sure

Guide "How to check your registration on EmaraTax" and a task "Check corporate tax registration". The item stays unknown.

Step 7. VAT

SCREEN TITLE

"VAT" · Question 1: "Is the company registered for VAT?" Yes, No, Not sure.

If Yes

Field	Required	Rules and validation	Why we ask (shown to the user)
VAT number (TRN)	optional	15 digits	Same reason line as corporate tax
Filing period	yes or skip	Quarterly, Monthly	Return dates
End date of your current or last tax period	yes or skip	Date	"It is on your VAT certificate. The FTA sets which months your quarters end."

Return and payment due **28 days after each tax period ends** (Decree-Law 8 of 2017 Art. 64, u.ae confirmed). Reminders 14, 7, 1 days before.

If No

Field	Required	Rules and validation	Why we ask (shown to the user)
Taxable sales and imports in the last 12 months	yes	Below AED 187,500; Between 187,500 and 375,000; Above 375,000; Not sure	This is the legal test
Do you expect them to pass AED 375,000 in the next 30 days?	yes	Yes, No, Not sure	This is the second legal test

Last 12 months above 375,000 OR next 30 days = Yes
 → "You must register for VAT." Guide. (30-day application window shown as unverified)
 Between 187,500 and 375,000
 → "You can choose to register." Guide. No deadline.
 Below 187,500
 → "Not required now." Monthly email: "Have your sales in the last 12 months passed AED 187,500 or 375,000?"
 Not sure (either question)
 → Task "Ask your accountant about VAT". Item stays unknown.

Rule: registration is mandatory when taxable supplies and imports passed AED 375,000 over the previous 12 months, or are expected to pass it in the next 30 days; voluntary above AED 187,500 (FTA VAT registration **confirmed**). The 30 days to apply come from the VAT Executive Regulation, **unverified** at article level.

If Not sure

Guide "How to check on EmaraTax" and a task. The item stays unknown.

Step 8. Your year

THE PAYOFF SCREEN

No questions. This is where the user sees the value.

#	Block	Content
1	Next 3 things due	Date, what it is, who does it (you or your agent), one line on what to do.
2	Your year	Every dated item for the company. Sourced dates first. Each shows its grade.
3	We still need	Every unknown or skipped item, the reason it matters, and who can answer (you, your agent, your accountant, the zone).
4	Your own documents	Passport, visa and Emirates ID of the signed-in person, across all their companies, shown once.
5	Email reminders	On by default to the account email. Option to add a second email per company (for example the agent).
6	Actions	Add another company (if the plan allows), Add employees (step 9), Go to dashboard.

Onboarding is complete when the company file exists and every item is known, unknown or skipped.

Step 9. Employees on visas (optional, after step 8)

Field	Required	Rules and validation	Why we ask (shown to the user)
Full name	yes	Text	Their visa dates
Passport expiry	skip allowed	Date	6-month passport rule
Residence visa expiry	skip allowed	Date	Visa reminders

Emirates ID expiry	skip allowed	Date	Emirates ID reminders
Files	optional	Uploads	Vault

Sponsor is this company. Same reminders as step 3. Updates "visas used". **No contracts, salary or WPS** (deferred).

6. Adding a second or third company

- Starts at step 1. The plan limit is checked there (1-company plan offers the upgrade to AED 90).
- Step 3 offers people already on the account as a pick list. Personal documents are reused; role, ownership and sponsor are asked again.
- Step 8 then shows a combined year across all companies, colour-coded by company, and "Your own documents" once.

7. Email reminders

Item	When emails go out
Licence, lease, establishment card, visas, Emirates IDs	90, 60, 30, 14, 7, 1 days before expiry
Lease	90, 60, 30 days before its end; always before the licence reminder
Passport	9 months and 6 months before expiry
Corporate tax registration (within 3 months)	30, 14, 7, 1 days before the deadline
Corporate tax return	90, 30, 7 days before the due date
VAT return	14, 7, 1 days before the due date
VAT threshold check (not registered, below threshold)	1st of each month
Unknown and skipped items	Weekly digest "We still need" until answered or dismissed

Every reminder email contains

- Company name, item, due date, days left.
- What to do in one line, and who does it (you or your agent).
- What happens if it is missed, in words, with source (section 8).
- A link to the item in the portal.

Sending rules for the developer

- Every send is logged (item, threshold, date, recipient, result).
- Never send twice for the same item, threshold and date.
- If the date changes, pending reminders are cancelled and rescheduled.
- Once an item is marked done with evidence, its remaining reminders stop.
- Days are counted in UAE time (Asia/Dubai).

8. Consequences: what happens if something is missed

Shown in words only, with the source. No amounts, by design.

Item	What happens if missed	Source and grade
Licence renewal	Depends on the zone: grace period or none, penalties, services blocked, visas affected, and in the end suspension, strike-off or termination. Full per-zone text in Appendix A.	Appendix A, per zone
Lease or desk contract	In zones where confirmed, the licence cannot be renewed without a valid lease.	Confirmed for 11 zones (Appendix A)
Establishment card	Visas cannot be issued or renewed while it is expired.	Ajman Free Zone confirmed ; other zones unknown
Passport under 6 months	The residence visa cannot be renewed until the passport is renewed.	ICP confirmed
Residence visa	After expiry a grace period applies that depends on the visa category (30, 60, 90 or 180 days); after that the person is in breach of residency rules.	ICP confirmed
Emirates ID	Renewal follows the visa; a late renewal carries a penalty.	unverified
Corporate tax registration	A late registration penalty applies. A waiver may apply if the first return is filed within 7 months of the first period end (status to recheck).	FTA confirmed ; waiver status unverified
Corporate tax return and payment	Late filing and late payment penalties apply.	FTA confirmed
VAT registration (when mandatory)	A penalty applies for failing to register on time.	FTA confirmed
VAT return and payment	Late filing and late payment penalties apply.	u.ae confirmed
Audited accounts (QFZP)	Required to keep the free zone tax status; missing them puts the status at risk.	MD 84 of 2025 confirmed ; detail unverified

RULE FOR THE DEVELOPER

Every consequence text lives in content with its source and grade, never in code. Unverified ones are shown with the word "unverified" or held back until confirmed, as marked.

9. Data the onboarding produces

Entity	Fields	Notes
Account	Paying person, email, plan, terms version and date	One per subscription
Company	Authority id, name, licence number, legal form, licence status, issue date, expiry date, term, incorporation date, activities, website, handler (self, agent with name and email, zone, unknown)	Jurisdiction is read from the authority file; no separate field
Person	Name, email, passport expiry, residence visa (sponsor kind, sponsoring company if on the account, expiry), Emirates ID expiry	One per human on the account
Role	Person, company, shareholder / manager / both, ownership %	Person-in-company
Office	Company, type, end date, renews with licence	
Company card	Company, kind, expiry	Kind: establishment now; MOHRE and Chamber later (mainland)
Visa quota	Company, allowed, used	
Corporate tax	Registered (yes, no, unknown), TRN, first period end, financial year end, QFZP intent (yes, no, unknown)	
VAT	Registered (yes, no, unknown), TRN, filing period, a period end, last 12 months band, next 30 days (yes, no, unknown)	
Document	File, kind, linked company or person, uploaded by, date	Vault
Task	Company, item, reason, who can answer, state	One per unknown or skipped item
Onboarding progress	Company, last step reached	Resume point
Waitlist entry	Email, emirate, date, consent	Mainland interest
Reminder log	Item, threshold, date, recipient, result	No double sends

EVERY USER-ENTERED VALUE CARRIES

state (known, unknown, skipped) · origin (user, later document) · date entered. Calculated and rule results are never stored.

10. Mainland: how the system leaves room for it

- The authority file already says mainland or free zone, and who sponsors visas (MOHRE or the zone). The company stores only the authority id.
- Mainland adds conditional fields only, no new steps: MOHRE establishment card and Chamber of Commerce membership as company card kinds (step 5); Ejari number on the office (step 4); work permit expiry per employee (step 9).
- Corporate tax, VAT, passport, visa and Emirates ID are federal and identical.

- Until then, choosing mainland shows "coming soon" and saves a waitlist entry.

11. Rules, sources and how sure we are

Rule	Grade	Source
CT registration within 3 months of incorporation (incorporated on or after 1 Mar 2024)	confirmed	FTA Decision 3 of 2024
CT registration, incorporated before 1 Mar 2024: all deadlines passed in 2024; unregistered now means late	confirmed	FTA Decision 3 of 2024
CT return and payment 9 months after tax period end	confirmed	FTA news
First tax period 6 to 18 months	confirmed	FTA CTP003
Late CT registration waiver (first return within 7 months)	unverified for Sept 2026	FTA waiver page; FTA news
Audited accounts for QFZP, or revenue above AED 50m	confirmed	MD 84 of 2025
VAT mandatory 375,000 (past 12 months or next 30 days), voluntary 187,500	confirmed	FTA VAT registration
VAT: 30 days to apply once mandatory	unverified	VAT Executive Regulation
VAT return and payment 28 days after period end	confirmed	u.ae
Passport 6 months to renew a residence visa (federal)	confirmed	ICP
Establishment card valid for visa services	confirmed Ajman FZ only	afz.gov.ae
Lease must be valid to renew the licence	confirmed 11 zones	Appendix A
After-expiry consequences per zone	30 confirmed, 9 reported, 3 unknown	Appendix A
Emirates ID follows visa expiry	unverified	none yet

12. Open decisions

#	Decision	Recommendation
1	When the subscription is charged: at account creation, or at step 8	At step 8, after the user sees their year
2	Which free zones get deep content first	CEO to choose

13. What is not in onboarding

These come in the system after onboarding:

- Renew, cancel and amend workflows (full workflows, per zone)

- Visa renewal stages and visa processes
- Health insurance tracking per visa holder
- UBO filing card (uses step 3 ownership)
- Corporate tax and VAT deregistration on cancellation
- ESR history (years up to 2022)
- Record keeping duty (7 years)
- Invites and access for agents and accountants
- Zone annual filings
- Deferred: employee contracts, WPS, salary, nationality, Emiratization, integrations, document scanner

14. Glossary

Free zone	An area with its own licensing authority, for example IFZA, DMCC, RAKEZ.
Mainland	Licensed by an emirate's economic department (for example DET in Dubai).
Establishment card	Also immigration card. Lets the company sponsor visas.
Visa quota	How many visas the company may sponsor.
Emirates ID (EID)	The UAE identity card for residents.
FTA	Federal Tax Authority. Runs EmaraTax, the tax portal.
TRN	Tax registration number (corporate tax or VAT).
Tax period	The period a return covers. Corporate tax: usually the financial year. VAT: quarterly or monthly.
QFZP	Qualifying Free Zone Person: a free zone company that meets conditions to pay 0% on qualifying income.
ICP	Federal Authority for Identity, Citizenship, Customs and Port Security. Residence visas and Emirates ID.
UBO	Ultimate beneficial owner records.
Agent or partner	A company that files with the zone on the licensee's behalf.
Grade	confirmed = official source; reported = secondary source only; unknown = no source yet.

Appendix A. Free zone renewal facts, all 42 zones

Researched 28 September 2026 from each zone's official sources where available. Amounts removed by design. "unknown" means no source was found; the portal shows "unknown" and who to ask.

Abu Dhabi Airports Free Zone

unknown

Lease at renewal unknown

When to renew unknown

Renews together unknown

If late unknown

Notes All adafz.ae pages and regulation PDFs returned HTTP 403. Search snippets from the ADAFZ licence regulations mention that renewal fees are paid under clause 6 of Part 2, that ADAC gives written notice of renewal, and that temporary licences are not renewable. The renewal timing clause could not be read.

Sources www.adafz.ae/en/-/media/F12AFEAF863F4600BD904A40A04F01FF.ash · www.adafz.ae/english/media/000726-license%20regulations_orig · www.adafz.ae/en/registration-and-licensing

Abu Dhabi Global Market (ADGM)

confirmed

Lease at renewal No minimum remaining term found. Official ADGM Registration Authority renewal guidance (Ver4.1, 2019) says the renewal application must include a valid Certificate of Registration of Lease (the lease must be registered with ADGM), or a consent letter for entities that share an office with a service provider, holding company or parent. No 90-day or other minimum remaining term is stated.

When to renew unknown. Official guidance says only that the commercial licence must be renewed every year on the entity's registration anniversary. No early renewal window is stated.

Renews together A valid registered lease (Certificate of Registration of Lease) or consent letter is uploaded with the renewal application. No official statement found about the establishment card or insurance renewing at the same time.

If late The official ADGM late filings page lists late commercial licence renewal as a monthly late fee, capped at three months. It also says unpaid fees lead to suspension of access to certain Registrar services (certificates and documents) after 30 days. A one-month grace period after expiry with no late fee appears in an ADGM consultation announcement, but only through a search summary. The page opened did not show that wording. The official guidance says the Registrar can suspend or withdraw a licence and can strike off an entity, but no day threshold for strike-off or deregistration after non-renewal was found.

Notes The lease document requirement and the annual renewal on the registration anniversary are confirmed from ADGM's own PDF. The one-month grace period is reported only, and its exact current wording is unverified. The ADGM rulebook pages (thomsonreuters) returned 403 and could not be read.

Sources www.adgm.com/documents/operating-in-adgm/ongoing-obligation/ · assets.adgm.com/download/assets/license_renewal_guide_update · assets.adgm.com/download/assets/LicenseRenewalGuideUpdated+v · www.adgm.com/operating-in-adgm/monitoring-and-enforcement/la · www.adgm.com/media/announcements/abu-dhabi-global-market-iss · www.adgm.com/faqs/setting-up

Ajman Free Zone (AFZ)

confirmed

Lease at renewal	unknown
When to renew	unknown for the licence. Official FAQ: the establishment card can be renewed early, within 2 months before its expiry.
Renews together	Official FAQ: the establishment card expiry is not linked to the trade licence expiry (they renew separately). Renewed documents (trade licence, establishment card, COC certificate) appear in the service request, and E-channel must be updated to renew the establishment card. Lease renewal together with the licence: unknown from an official source.
If late	Official FAQ: a grace period of one month after licence expiry, within which renewal is possible. What happens after that (suspension or deregistration timing) is unknown from an official source. Consultancies mention suspension of activity (reported).
Notes	No 90-day lease rule found.
Sources	afz.gov.ae/en/help-and-support/faqs.html · afz.gov.ae/en/start-your-business/product/offices.html

Ajman Media City Free Zone (AMCFZ)

unknown

Lease at renewal	unknown
When to renew	unknown
Renews together	unknown
If late	unknown. Consultancies apply the Ajman Free Zone one-month grace period to AMC, but no AMC source confirms it.
Notes	The official AMC FAQ says only that licences are generally valid for 1 year from issue and that multi-year licences are available. The AMC rules page has no renewal content. The AMC site links to the AFZ e-portal, but AFZ rules were not confirmed to apply to AMC.
Sources	amc.gov.ae/faq · amc.gov.ae/rules-regulations · amc.gov.ae/

Creative City (Fujairah Creative City Media Free Zone)

confirmed

Lease at renewal	unknown (the official rules set no lease-remaining rule. The 30-day rule applies to licence validity, see renewalWindow)
When to renew	Official Rules and Regulations (June 2025) 1.14: licences must be renewed before expiry. 1.15: submit renewal or cancellation requirements well before expiry, because Creative City cannot process any service request once licence validity is under 30 days. 1.5: renewal can be for 1 to 10 years.
Renews together	Official rules: the establishment card, if one exists, is tracked separately, with a fine after 28 days past card expiry (1.16). Residence visas must be renewed or cancelled before expiry (2.3). Lease or flexi desk renewal: unknown.
If late	Official rules 1.16: if not renewed or cancelled within the period, a capped monthly late fine applies. 1.17: services may be suspended for overdue payments. 1.22: 90 days after licence expiry, Creative City may take legal action and demand settlement of fines on the licence and visas. No automatic deregistration threshold is stated. A consultancy claim of annulment after 60 days is not in the official rules.
Notes	The 90-day figure here is a licence-expiry enforcement threshold, not a lease-remaining rule.
Sources	creativitycity.gov.ae/wp-content/uploads/2026/04/Rules_and_Reg

Dubai Airport Free Zone (DAFZA)

reported

Lease at renewal	unknown
When to renew	unknown (consultancies recommend starting at least 30 days before expiry)
Renews together	unknown from official sources. Consultancies say renewal covers the licence fee, facility lease and establishment card, and that the lease and audited financial statements are submitted. If DIEZA regulations apply (see notes), a UBO declaration is due on each renewal under reg 22.2.
If late	unknown from DAFZA's own site. DIEZA Implementing Regulations 2023, reg 106(c), make failure to renew a discretionary ground for the Registrar to wind up the company, with no day threshold. Consultancies say the establishment card and visas are frozen after expiry. Consultancy claims about the grace period conflict (one says 10 days, others say penalties start after a grace period).
Notes	dafz.ae returned no content. DAFZA falls under DIEZA, the Dubai Integrated Economic Zones Authority (general knowledge, not verified here). The DIEZA regulations were opened from dso.ae.
Sources	dafz.ae/en/ · dso.ae/documents/d/dubai-silicon-oasis/dieza_implementing_re

Dubai Auto Zone

reported

Lease at renewal	unknown. If Jafza rules apply (not confirmed for DAZ on an official page), the lease must be valid to renew the licence.
When to renew	unknown for DAZ specifically. Jafza's official renew-licence page allows renewal within three months before expiry, but it does not say this applies to DAZ.
Renews together	unknown
If late	unknown
Notes	Consultancies (uaefreezone.org and others) say JAFZA supervises and licenses DAZ (formerly DUCAMZ). A Dubai Trade search snippet lists DAZ as a licensing authority next to Jafza, NIP and Textile City. The Dubai Trade DAZ announcement pages blocked the fetch, so this could not be confirmed. Treat Jafza rules as unverified for DAZ.
Sources	www.jafza.ae/resource-centre/guides/renew-license/ · www.dubaitrade.ae/en/news-announcements/dubai-auto-zone · www.dubaitrade.ae/en/news-announcements/dubai-auto-zone?star

Dubai CommerCity (DCC)

unknown

Lease at renewal	unknown
When to renew	unknown
Renews together	unknown
If late	unknown
Notes	The official DCC FAQ and site pages have no renewal, lease-renewal or expiry rules. The one consultancy page opened (filings.ae) gives renewal costs only, with no timing or consequences. DCC is a DAFZA-linked zone, but no DCC-specific renewal regulation was found.
Sources	www.dubaicommercity.ae/faq · filings.ae/anc-free-zone/dubai-commercity-cost

Dubai Design District

confirmed

Lease at renewal	unknown. No minimum lease period at renewal was found in official sources. A registered office in the zone is required at all times (PCR 2016 reg 51.2).
When to renew	unknown as a rule. Renew on AXS before expiry. The in5/TECOM note gives reminders at 45, 30, 15 and 0 days before expiry.
Renews together	Lease or occupation licence agreement, the Establishment Card (same expiry as the licence), and third party liability and workmen's compensation insurance for visa employees. These come from the in5/TECOM note.
If late	Same as Dubai Internet City. DDA Decision 1/2021 Schedule 4 sets escalating penalties at more than 30, 60 and 90 days after expiry, with no grace period. DDA may refuse renewal and visa sponsorship services. Suspension, revocation or cancellation is possible under Licensing Regulations reg 10.1.5. Deregistration can follow three months after written notice under PCR 2016 reg 100.
Notes	All nine zones share the DDA rules, see the Dubai Internet City notes. d3 is licensed by DDA and named in Decision 1/2021. 'Confirmed' covers the late renewal consequences only.
Sources	dda.gov.ae/-/media/67662280247F46F2B94A853943F014C4.pdf · dda.gov.ae/-/media/07DE5215EC064FC990A6D5965955BD79.pdf · dda.gov.ae/-/media/7342AF827E3643E68CAE10D72C883146.pdf · infive.ae/setup/wp-content/uploads/2020/08/Renewal-Process-N

Dubai HealthCare City

confirmed

Lease at renewal	unknown. No minimum remaining period is stated. The official DHCR Client Handbook lists a 'Valid Lease Agreement' as a required renewal document for FZ-LLC natural person, FZ-LLC corporate and branch entities.
When to renew	The DHCR system sends an automatic Licence Renewal Notification 60 days before expiry (official Client Handbook). No explicit earliest or latest submission rule was found. The commercial licence is valid for one year and renewable annually.
Renews together	Renewal documents include a valid lease agreement, an NOC from the relevant external authority if applicable, and for branches a Good Standing Certificate of the parent or a valid UAE trade licence. Property management and hotel licences also need a Civil Defence 24/7 security certificate and Fire and Peril insurance. Establishment card: unknown.
If late	Official handbook: if the commercial licence is not renewed, or the business is not operating, the authority will start licence cancellation and deregistration under DHCR Regulations. No grace period or day threshold was found.
Notes	Source is the DHCR ROC Client Handbook (PDF on dhcc.ae). Service time for renewal is 1 working day. Day thresholds after expiry could not be found in any official source.
Sources	www.dhcc.ae/gallery/DHCR%20ROC%20Client%20Handbook.pdf

Dubai Humanitarian City

confirmed

Lease at renewal	unknown. No minimum remaining period is stated. IHC Regulations Art. 14 require a valid Lease to be licensed. The Authority may repossess property if the Lease or License is not renewed or cancelled within the stipulated timeframe.
When to renew	Official: the renewal request, fees and documents must be submitted no later than 60 days before each renewal date (IHC Regulations Art. 65). Licence term is two years from issue (Art. 19).
Renews together	Official: at renewal of any License, Lease or Sponsorship Agreement, evidence of renewed insurance policies must be given (Art. 40). These are the insurances in Arts. 37 to 39, including employee injury and disability cover. The fee schedule lists Establishment Card renewal and late renewal as separate services. The renewal must also show compliance and being actively operational in prior years (Art. 66).
If late	Official: the Authority may terminate a licence if the entity fails to renew its expired licence or has not paid a renewal or late renewal fee (Art. 72(a)(v),(vii)). It may also terminate if activities have ceased for more than 90 days (Art. 72(a)(iv)). The Authority may suspend a licence at its discretion (Arts. 70 and 71). Strike-off (Art. 74) runs as follows. After the termination notice, the entity has 20 Business Days to respond. Then a Second Strike-Off Notice gives 60 Business Days, or another period the Authority sets, plus a Public Notice. After that the entity may be struck off and removed from the Register. No fixed day count from expiry to termination.
Notes	Source is the IHC Regulations (Version 2022) PDF on dubaihumanitarian.ae . Sub-leasing is not permitted.
Sources	dubaihumanitarian.ae/wp-content/uploads/2023/01/IHC-Regulati

Dubai International Academic City

confirmed

Lease at renewal	unknown. No minimum lease period at renewal was found in official sources. A registered office in the zone is required at all times (PCR 2016 reg 51.2).
When to renew	unknown as a rule. Renew on AXS before expiry. The in5/TECOM note gives reminders at 45, 30, 15 and 0 days before expiry.
Renews together	Lease or occupation licence agreement, the Establishment Card (same expiry as the licence), and third party liability and workmen's compensation insurance for visa employees. These come from the in5/TECOM note. Education activities may also need NOCs from outside authorities at renewal (DDA commercial licence renewal page; Decision 1/2021 art. 8.2).
If late	Same as Dubai Internet City. DDA Decision 1/2021 Schedule 4 sets escalating penalties at more than 30, 60 and 90 days after expiry, with no grace period. DDA may refuse renewal and visa sponsorship services. Suspension, revocation or cancellation is possible under Licensing Regulations reg 10.1.5. Deregistration can follow three months after written notice under PCR 2016 reg 100.
Notes	All nine zones share the DDA rules, see the Dubai Internet City notes. 'Confirmed' covers the late renewal consequences only.
Sources	dda.gov.ae/-/media/67662280247F46F2B94A853943F014C4.pdf · dda.gov.ae/-/media/07DE5215EC064FC990A6D5965955BD79.pdf · dda.gov.ae/-/media/7342AF827E3643E68CAE10D72C883146.pdf · dda.gov.ae/en/registration-licensing/existing-businesses/lic · infive.ae/setup/wp-content/uploads/2020/08/Renewal-Process-N

Dubai International Financial Centre (DIFC)

confirmed

Lease at renewal	unknown. No minimum remaining lease period found in the official DIFC Operating Law or Operating Regulations. Operating Regulations 5.1.1 require the registered office to be a location in the DIFC. A consultancy (Atlas) says lapsed lease or registered address arrangements hold up renewal, but gives no day threshold.
When to renew	Must be renewed before expiry (Operating Regulations 2.9.1). No official 'earliest' window found. A licence runs 12 months from issue (Operating Law Art. 9(9)).
Renews together	A Confirmation Statement must be delivered at the same time as the licence renewal application (Operating Regulations 5.2.1), confirming filed information and whether Ultimate Beneficial Owners or Nominee Directors changed. Lease and establishment card renewal alongside: unknown from official sources.
If late	Official: a late renewal application can be made. Within 30 days of expiry, if granted, the licence is deemed to have continued and no fine applies. After 30 days, if granted, it is deemed continued but an automatic fine applies (Operating Regulations 2.9.3; Operating Law Art. 9(11) and (12), Registrar may waive). A licensee not renewing must notify the Registrar before expiry of its intention and wind-down steps (Reg 2.9.4). Strike-off: the Registrar may strike a Registered Person off the Public Register if it is not carrying on business or is in contravention of the Law or Regulations, after publishing a notice of intention (Operating Law Art. 32(1) and (2)). No fixed day count after expiry at which strike-off happens was found.
Notes	The 30-day 'no fine' late renewal window is official. Consultancies also say renew at least 30 days before expiry. That is advice, not a rule. Fine amounts were left out on purpose.
Sources	assets.difc.com/v1/media/edge/images/dubaiintern0078-difcexp · www.difc.com/business/laws-and-regulations/legal-database/di · edge.sitecorecloud.io/dubaiintern0078-difcexperie96c5-produc · www.icnl.org/wp-content/uploads/United-Arab-Emirates_23_UAE_

Dubai Internet City

confirmed

Lease at renewal	unknown. No official DDA or TECOM source found that sets a minimum lease period remaining at licence renewal (no '90 days remaining' rule found). The official sources say only that a company must always have a registered office in the zone (DDA Private Companies Regulations 2016, reg 51.2). An in5 (TECOM) renewal note says the lease (occupation licence agreement) and the company licence must both be valid at all times, and it describes renewing the lease first, then the licence.
When to renew	unknown for a fixed opening date. DDA says to renew online through the AXS portal before expiry. The in5 (TECOM) note says DDA emails renewal reminders 45, 30, 15 and 0 days before licence expiry, and the leasing team sends lease renewal notices 60, 30 and 0 days before lease expiry. These are reminder dates, not a rule on how early you may renew.
Renews together	Lease or occupation licence agreement, renewed with TECOM leasing before the licence. The licence renewal on AXS selects the registered office, and a Letter of Good Standing is needed for a corporate shareholder. The Establishment Card from GDRFA Dubai has the same expiry date as the licence and must be renewed after the licence; GDRFA sends no reminder. For employees on the company visa, the in5 note also lists third party liability and workmen's compensation insurance at lease renewal. (The Establishment Card and insurance points come from the in5/TECOM note only.)
If late	DDA Decision No. 1 of 2021 (Licence Categories), Schedule 4: if the licence is not renewed on or before expiry, a late renewal penalty is added to the next year's fee. The penalty rises in steps at more than 30 days, more than 60 days and more than 90 days after expiry. No grace period is stated. DDA may refuse to renew the licence, and may refuse government services, including visa sponsorship services. The Licensing Regulations 2003 (reg 10.1.5) let DDA suspend, revoke or cancel a licence by written notice if renewal fees or late renewal penalties are unpaid, with no fixed day count. The Private Companies Regulations 2016 (reg 100) say that if a company breaches the regulations, including by ceasing business in the zone, DDA gives written notice. It can then deregister the company and strike it off after three months, unless the company gives a reasonable justification. No automatic termination at a fixed number of days after expiry was found. The 90 day mark in Schedule 4 is only a penalty step. In the in5 note, TECOM leasing starts lease termination if the lease is not renewed, and access cards are disabled at expiry.
Notes	Dubai Internet City, Dubai Media City, Dubai Knowledge Park, Dubai International Academic City, Dubai Outsource City, Dubai Production City, Dubai Studio City, Dubai Science Park and Dubai Design District are all licensed by the Dubai Development Authority (DDA) under one set of rules. DDA Decision No. 1 of 2021 names all nine zones in its title. The Licensing Regulations 2003 and the Private Companies Regulations 2016 apply to all of them, so the findings are the same for every zone. Grade 'confirmed' covers the late renewal consequences, which come from official DDA regulations. The lease minimum is unknown. The renewal window, the Establishment Card and the insurance points come from an in5 note dated 2020. in5 is TECOM Group's own incubator, so this is an operator document, not a regulation. Treat those points as reported. Decision 1/2021 is the latest licence categories decision listed on the DDA legal database; a later amendment could not be ruled out. The deregistration timeline in reg 100 applies to companies; branches follow a separate process. Licence validity is one year (DIC FAQ).
Sources	dda.gov.ae/en/registration-licensing/existing-businesses/lic · dda.gov.ae/en/registration-licensing/existing-businesses/lic · dda.gov.ae/en/registration-licensing/existing-businesses/lic · dda.gov.ae/en/legal-database/laws-and-regulations · dda.gov.ae/en/legal-database/circulars-and-announcements · dda.gov.ae/-/media/67662280247F46F2B94A853943F014C4.pdf · dda.gov.ae/-/media/07DE5215EC064FC990A6D5965955BD79.pdf · dda.gov.ae/-/media/7342AF827E3643E68CAE10D72C883146.pdf · dda.gov.ae/-/media/0074B5AB0C354D11B6C861AC4DD063CD.pdf · dda.gov.ae/-/media/8876FE5F2A97411B92666F11EC59C690.pdf · www.dic.ae/connect/faqs · infive.ae/setup/wp-content/uploads/2020/08/Renewal-Process-N

Dubai Knowledge Park

confirmed

Lease at renewal	unknown. No minimum lease period at renewal was found in official sources. A registered office in the zone is required at all times (PCR 2016 reg 51.2).
When to renew	unknown as a rule. Renew on AXS before expiry. The in5/TECOM note gives reminders at 45, 30, 15 and 0 days before expiry for the licence, and 60, 30 and 0 days for the lease.
Renews together	Lease or occupation licence agreement first, then the licence, then the Establishment Card, which has the same expiry as the licence. Third party liability and workmen's compensation insurance for visa employees. These points come from the in5/TECOM note. The AXS counter for lease renewal is in Dubai Knowledge Park, Block 8.
If late	Same as Dubai Internet City. DDA Decision 1/2021 Schedule 4 sets escalating penalties at more than 30, 60 and 90 days after expiry, with no grace period. DDA may refuse renewal and visa sponsorship services. Suspension, revocation or cancellation is possible under Licensing Regulations reg 10.1.5, with no day count. Deregistration can follow three months after written notice under PCR 2016 reg 100.
Notes	All nine zones share the DDA rules, see the Dubai Internet City notes. 'Confirmed' covers the late renewal consequences only.
Sources	dda.gov.ae/-/media/67662280247F46F2B94A853943F014C4.pdf · dda.gov.ae/-/media/07DE5215EC064FC990A6D5965955BD79.pdf · dda.gov.ae/-/media/7342AF827E3643E68CAE10D72C883146.pdf · infive.ae/setup/wp-content/uploads/2020/08/Renewal-Process-N

Dubai Maritime City

reported

Lease at renewal	unknown. Consultancies say renewal needs a signed lease agreement for the facility.
When to renew	Reported: the DMCA e-services listing for 'Renewal - Foreign Establishment/Company License' says to apply within a month from licence expiry. This comes from a search-engine snippet only; the page itself returned 403 (Cloudflare) and could not be opened.
Renews together	Reported (Shuraa): renewal fee plus a signed lease agreement. From the second renewal, an annual audit report.
If late	unknown
Notes	It is unclear from official sources whether DMCA is the company licensing authority for all Dubai Maritime City free zone companies. DMCA also issues separate maritime activity permits, renewed annually. The DMCA e-services pages block automated fetch. Verify by hand.
Sources	eservices.dmca.ae/en/Services/ServiceDetails/f77ae05d-572a-e · eservices.dmca.ae/en/Services/ServiceDetails/c57ae05d-572a-e · pcfc.ae/en/Pages/serviceinfo.aspx?BU=Dubai+Maritime+Authorit · www.shuraa.com/business-setup-in-dmc-dubai-maritime-city-fre

Dubai Media City

confirmed

Lease at renewal	unknown. No official source sets a minimum lease period remaining at renewal. A company must always have a registered office in the zone (DDA Private Companies Regulations 2016, reg 51.2). An in5 (TECOM) note says the lease and the licence must always be valid, with the lease renewed first.
When to renew	unknown as a rule. DDA: renew online on AXS before expiry. From the in5/TECOM note: DDA reminders at 45, 30, 15 and 0 days before expiry; lease reminders at 60, 30 and 0 days before expiry.
Renews together	Lease or occupation licence agreement, renewed before the licence. The Establishment Card (GDRFA Dubai) has the same expiry as the licence and is renewed after it. Third party liability and workmen's compensation insurance for visa employees are listed at lease renewal. These points come from the in5/TECOM note.
If late	Same as Dubai Internet City. DDA Decision 1/2021 Schedule 4 sets escalating late renewal penalties at more than 30, more than 60 and more than 90 days after expiry. There is no stated grace period. DDA may refuse renewal and government or visa sponsorship services. The Licensing Regulations 2003 (reg 10.1.5) allow suspension, revocation or cancellation for unpaid renewal fees or penalties, with no fixed day count. The Private Companies Regulations 2016 (reg 100) allow deregistration and strike-off three months after a written notice of breach, including ceasing business in the zone. There is no automatic termination at a fixed day count.
Notes	All nine zones share the DDA rules, see the Dubai Internet City notes. 'Confirmed' covers the late renewal consequences only. The lease minimum is unknown. The renewal window and the documents that renew together are reported from the in5 (TECOM) note.
Sources	dda.gov.ae/-/media/67662280247F46F2B94A853943F014C4.pdf · dda.gov.ae/-/media/07DE5215EC064FC990A6D5965955BD79.pdf · dda.gov.ae/-/media/7342AF827E3643E68CAE10D72C883146.pdf · dda.gov.ae/en/registration-licensing/existing-businesses/lic · infive.ae/setup/wp-content/uploads/2020/08/Renewal-Process-N

Dubai Multi Commodities Centre (DMCC)

confirmed

Lease at renewal	For DMCC Business Centre units, the official Licence Renewal Guidelines tell you to select 'Renew Lease' if the lease is valid for less than 90 days. If the lease has expired or has less than 90 days left, it can be renewed in the same service request as the licence. Leased units need an Ejari number, or a tenancy contract and title deed where Ejari does not apply. Licensing Rule 3.3.3(c) says there must be no arrears on the Lease.
When to renew	Rule 3.3.1: licences must be renewed on or before the expiry date on the licence. No official advance window found (unknown).
Renews together	The lease can be renewed in the same service request when it has under 90 days left or has expired. To renew you need: audited financial statements (Rule 3.3.3(b)), valid licences, permits, visas and approvals (3.3.3(a)), workmen's compensation insurance for active employees, third-party liability insurance for physical units, and operational fitness certificates. The guidelines do not say whether the establishment card renews in the same step (unknown).
If late	Rule 3.3.4: if the licence is not renewed by expiry, the Registrar may, at its discretion, allow a limited grace period to finish renewal. The length of that period is not stated. If renewal is not done within the grace period, the licence may be suspended or terminated under Rule 5 (by written notice, effective on the date in the notice). Rule 5.4 allows a Sanction and/or Strike-off. Rule 3.3.2 says no business may be carried on without a valid licence. The guidelines say a sanction goes on the member account and penalties apply. The lease late-renewal penalty starts from the lease expiry date. No fixed day threshold for suspension or strike-off found.
Notes	The 90-day lease figure is stated for DMCC Business Centre units in the renewal guidelines. The source does not say it applies to every property type. Licensing Rules Version 3, issued 10 October 2024.
Sources	dmcc.ae/members/support/knowledge-bank/licence-renewal-guide · dmcc.ae/hubfs/Compliance%20Documents%202024/Licensing%20Rule

Dubai Outsource City

confirmed

Lease at renewal	unknown. No minimum lease period at renewal was found in official sources. A registered office in the zone is required at all times (PCR 2016 reg 51.2).
When to renew	unknown as a rule. Renew on AXS before expiry. The in5/TECOM note gives reminders at 45, 30, 15 and 0 days before expiry.
Renews together	Lease or occupation licence agreement, the Establishment Card (same expiry as the licence), and third party liability and workmen's compensation insurance for visa employees. These come from the in5/TECOM note.
If late	Same as Dubai Internet City. DDA Decision 1/2021 Schedule 4 sets escalating penalties at more than 30, 60 and 90 days after expiry, with no grace period. DDA may refuse renewal and visa sponsorship services. Suspension, revocation or cancellation is possible under Licensing Regulations reg 10.1.5. Deregistration can follow three months after written notice under PCR 2016 reg 100.
Notes	All nine zones share the DDA rules, see the Dubai Internet City notes. 'Confirmed' covers the late renewal consequences only.
Sources	dda.gov.ae/-/media/67662280247F46F2B94A853943F014C4.pdf · dda.gov.ae/-/media/07DE5215EC064FC990A6D5965955BD79.pdf · dda.gov.ae/-/media/7342AF827E3643E68CAE10D72C883146.pdf · infive.ae/setup/wp-content/uploads/2020/08/Renewal-Process-N

Dubai Production City

confirmed

Lease at renewal	unknown. No minimum lease period at renewal was found in official sources. A registered office in the zone is required at all times (PCR 2016 reg 51.2).
When to renew	unknown as a rule. Renew on AXS before expiry. The in5/TECOM note gives reminders at 45, 30, 15 and 0 days before expiry.
Renews together	Lease or occupation licence agreement, the Establishment Card (same expiry as the licence), and third party liability and workmen's compensation insurance for visa employees. These come from the in5/TECOM note.
If late	Same as Dubai Internet City. DDA Decision 1/2021 Schedule 4 sets escalating penalties at more than 30, 60 and 90 days after expiry, with no grace period. DDA may refuse renewal and visa sponsorship services. Suspension, revocation or cancellation is possible under Licensing Regulations reg 10.1.5. Deregistration can follow three months after written notice under PCR 2016 reg 100.
Notes	All nine zones share the DDA rules, see the Dubai Internet City notes. 'Confirmed' covers the late renewal consequences only.
Sources	dda.gov.ae/-/media/67662280247F46F2B94A853943F014C4.pdf · dda.gov.ae/-/media/07DE5215EC064FC990A6D5965955BD79.pdf · dda.gov.ae/-/media/7342AF827E3643E68CAE10D72C883146.pdf · infive.ae/setup/wp-content/uploads/2020/08/Renewal-Process-N

Dubai Science Park

confirmed

Lease at renewal	unknown. No minimum lease period at renewal was found in official sources. A registered office in the zone is required at all times (PCR 2016 reg 51.2).
When to renew	unknown as a rule. Renew on AXS before expiry. The in5/TECOM note gives reminders at 45, 30, 15 and 0 days before expiry.
Renews together	Lease or occupation licence agreement, the Establishment Card (same expiry as the licence), and third party liability and workmen's compensation insurance for visa employees. These come from the in5/TECOM note. Health-related activities may also need NOCs from outside authorities at renewal (Decision 1/2021 art. 8.2).
If late	Same as Dubai Internet City. DDA Decision 1/2021 Schedule 4 sets escalating penalties at more than 30, 60 and 90 days after expiry, with no grace period. DDA may refuse renewal and visa sponsorship services. Suspension, revocation or cancellation is possible under Licensing Regulations reg 10.1.5. Deregistration can follow three months after written notice under PCR 2016 reg 100.
Notes	All nine zones share the DDA rules, see the Dubai Internet City notes. 'Confirmed' covers the late renewal consequences only.
Sources	dda.gov.ae/-/media/67662280247F46F2B94A853943F014C4.pdf · dda.gov.ae/-/media/07DE5215EC064FC990A6D5965955BD79.pdf · dda.gov.ae/-/media/7342AF827E3643E68CAE10D72C883146.pdf · infive.ae/setup/wp-content/uploads/2020/08/Renewal-Process-N

Dubai Silicon Oasis

reported

Lease at renewal	unknown (consultancies say a signed lease agreement is submitted at renewal)
When to renew	unknown (a search snippet of the dso.ae renewal page said to renew before expiry; the page itself would not render)
Renews together	The DIEZA Implementing Regulations 2023 (hosted on dso.ae), reg 22.2, require the UBO declaration on each licence renewal. Consultancies report a signed lease, audit report from the second renewal onward, and establishment card renewal. Not officially confirmed.
If late	DIEZA Implementing Regulations 2023, reg 106(c): failure to renew the licence is a ground on which the Registrar may, at its discretion, wind up the company. No day threshold is given. A search-engine snippet of dso.ae/to-renew-your-license describes a one-month grace period and a higher penalty after 3 months. The page did not render, so this is unverified. Consultancies report that the licence is blocked after a 30-day grace period and that strike-off can follow after 90 days (reported only).
Notes	Only the winding-up ground (reg 106(c)) and the UBO declaration at renewal are confirmed, from the official DIEZA regulations. The grace period and day thresholds are reported, not confirmed.
Sources	dso.ae/to-renew-your-license · dso.ae/faq · dso.ae/documents/d/dubai-silicon-oasis/dieza_implementing_re

Dubai South

reported

Lease at renewal	unknown (consultancies say a valid lease or flexi-desk agreement for the coming year is submitted)
When to renew	unknown (consultancies recommend 45 to 90 days ahead; not official)
Renews together	unknown (consultancies mention the establishment card and PO Box rental)
If late	unknown from rules. An official Dubai South press release lists 'exemption from late renewal fines' in a new incentive package for free zone companies. It gives no dates, scope or eligibility.
Notes	No official rules or renewal guide could be opened. Pages on dubaisouth.ae returned only navigation. Treat all timing as unknown.
Sources	www.dubaisouth.ae/en/gov-free-zone-service · www.dubaisouth.ae/en/work/freezone · dubaisouth.ae/business-setup-licensing/license · www.dubaisouth.ae/en/newsroom/dubai-south-introduces-new-inc

Dubai Studio City

confirmed

Lease at renewal	unknown. No minimum lease period at renewal was found in official sources. A registered office in the zone is required at all times (PCR 2016 reg 51.2).
When to renew	unknown as a rule. Renew on AXS before expiry. The in5/TECOM note gives reminders at 45, 30, 15 and 0 days before expiry.
Renews together	Lease or occupation licence agreement, the Establishment Card (same expiry as the licence), and third party liability and workmen's compensation insurance for visa employees. These come from the in5/TECOM note. Broadcast activities may also need NOCs from outside authorities at renewal (Decision 1/2021 art. 8.2).
If late	Same as Dubai Internet City. DDA Decision 1/2021 Schedule 4 sets escalating penalties at more than 30, 60 and 90 days after expiry, with no grace period. DDA may refuse renewal and visa sponsorship services. Suspension, revocation or cancellation is possible under Licensing Regulations reg 10.1.5. Deregistration can follow three months after written notice under PCR 2016 reg 100.
Notes	All nine zones share the DDA rules, see the Dubai Internet City notes. 'Confirmed' covers the late renewal consequences only.
Sources	dda.gov.ae/-/media/67662280247F46F2B94A853943F014C4.pdf · dda.gov.ae/-/media/07DE5215EC064FC990A6D5965955BD79.pdf · dda.gov.ae/-/media/7342AF827E3643E68CAE10D72C883146.pdf · infive.ae/setup/wp-content/uploads/2020/08/Renewal-Process-N

DWTC Free Zone

confirmed

Lease at renewal	No minimum number of days. Free Zone Rules (V10 and V12), licence rule 11.1: to retain and renew a licence you must hold a valid Lease in the Free Zone. The official renewal guide (August 2025) says the lease must be renewed and aligned with the licence dates. This applies to third-party business centres, subleases and standard offices, but not to business address, flexi desk, hot desk or executive office holders.
When to renew	The official renewal guide says document submission and payment must be completed before the expiry date. Rule 12 says licences shall be renewed no later than 30 days after expiry. No advance window found.
Renews together	The lease is renewed first as step 1, where applicable. The establishment card is renewed after the renewed licence is issued. Also required: an FTA tax registration certificate (or a declaration letter) and a UBO declaration if anything changed.
If late	Rule 12: renewal is due no later than 30 days after expiry, otherwise a fine or penalty applies. The renewal guide says separate monthly penalties apply to the licence and to the establishment card. If the licence is not renewed, all employee and dependant visas must be cancelled or transferred and cards returned. Anyone not cancelled or transferred is reported as absconding. Non-renewal also invalidates the Lease, and all dues and lease issues must be settled. Section 8: the Authority may revoke, cancel or suspend a licence on 30 days' written notice for failing to submit renewal documents or pay fees.
Notes	The penalty schedule caps the licence non-renewal fine; amounts are left out on purpose.
Sources	media.dwtc.com/Free-Zone-Rules-and-Regulations-V10.pdf · media.dwtc.com/Free-Zone-Rules-and-Regulations-V12.pdf · media.dwtc.com/License-Renewal-August-2025.pdf

Fujairah Free Zone (FFZA)

reported

Lease at renewal	unknown (a consultancy claim that the lease must be renewed first if more than 30 days of it have expired is not confirmed)
When to renew	unknown (consultancies say start at least 30 days or one month before expiry, reported only)
Renews together	unknown from an official source. The MOET registrar profile shows the lease agreement is issued with the trade licence. Consultancies say a valid tenancy contract is needed at renewal (reported).
If late	Reported only: escalating penalties after expiry, a lapsed licence suspends legal standing, and long lapses may require re-registration. No official day thresholds found.
Notes	The official site (fujairahfreezone.com or .ae) could not be reached: DNS failure, a certificate mismatch, and a 404 on the Operational Manual PDF. No 90-day lease rule found.
Sources	www.moet.gov.ae/documents/20121/416990/FUJ+freezone+Eng.pdf/ · bizstartuae.com/renew-fujairah-free-zone-license/

Gold and Diamond Park

confirmed

Lease at renewal	Official Jafza pages: the lease must be valid to renew the licence. No minimum remaining period is stated. A three-year licence renewal is allowed only where the plot or sublease has more than three years of validity.
When to renew	Official Jafza renew-licence page: can be renewed within three months before expiry. Jafza handles licensing for Gold and Diamond Park.
Renews together	Official Jafza renew-licence page: Gold and Diamond Park companies need an NOC from the Gold and Diamond Park Authority at renewal. Jafza lease renewal needs rent payment confirmation and updated workmen's compensation, third-party and fire insurance copies. Consultancies say renewal includes the establishment card; not confirmed officially.
If late	Official (Jafza Rules 9th edition tariff and renew page): a late payment fee applies to an expired licence on a monthly basis. Jafza offers a reinstatement service for customers whose registration was terminated by the Jafza Authority. No grace period or day threshold for suspension or termination was found. A consultancy (relocate-uae) claims cancellation if not renewed within 4 months; not verified.
Notes	Jafza's official news (2 Sep 2020) says Jafza handles all licensing and registration for Gold and Diamond Park and that companies there fall under Jafza's Free Zone Rules. The renewal window and lease rule therefore come from Jafza's official pages. Jafza now offers leases of 3 years or longer only (Dubai Trade announcement snippet, not opened).
Sources	www.jafza.ae/resource-centre/guides/renew-license/ · www.jafza.ae/resource-centre/media/news/jafza-signs-agreemen · www.jafza.ae/resource-centre/guides/lease-renewal/ · www.jafza.ae/resources/guides/registration-and-license-reins · www.jafza.ae/resource-centre/downloads/jafza-rules-regulatio

Hamriyah Free Zone (HFZA)

reported

Lease at renewal	unknown
When to renew	unknown (consultancies recommend starting at least 30 days before expiry, reported only)
Renews together	unknown from an official source. HFZA's MOET registrar profile shows that the lease agreement is issued alongside the licence at incorporation. Consultancies say a valid lease is needed at renewal (reported).
If late	HFZA FZE Implementing Rules (official): the FZE Unit may deregister an FZE for breach of the rules or licence terms if the breach is not remedied within 7 days of written notice, or if the FZE does not answer a written 'not carrying on business' enquiry within 7 days (arts. 22(C), 24(B)). Daily fines during non-compliance are possible (art. 25(B)). No licence-expiry-specific grace period is stated in an official source. Consultancies say there is no grace period and that long lapses may require re-registration (reported).
Notes	The official rules cover deregistration generally, not expiry thresholds. The HFZA FAQ and e-services pages have no renewal content. A claim that 'if more than 30 days of your lease have expired you must renew the lease first' appears only on consultancy sites and is not confirmed for HFZA. No 90-day lease rule found.
Sources	hfza.ae/wp-content/uploads/2020/09/HHFZA_Implementing_Rules_ · hfza.ae/faq/ · hfza.ae/e-service/s/ · www.moet.gov.ae/documents/20121/416990/Himriyah+ENG.pdf/6ffc · bizstartuae.com/renew-hamriyah-free-zone-license/

IFZA

confirmed

Lease at renewal	unknown (consultancies only say the flexi-desk or business address lease must be active at renewal. No official source found)
When to renew	The official IFZA guide says the licence must be renewed on or before the expiry date. No official advance window found (unknown). One consultancy says the portal accepts applications from 90 days before expiry (not verified).
Renews together	The official guide says financial statements are submitted with the renewal. A three-month preparation period after financial year-end is allowed. Third-party approvals must be in place before a regulated licence is issued. Signatory DocuSign/e-legal confirmation is needed if it was not done in the first 12 months. Consultancies report that the renewal quotation covers licence registration, establishment card renewal and commercial licence fee (not official). Lease: unknown.
If late	The official guide says an expired licence cannot be used to trade, banks may suspend accounts, and fines may be imposed. If not renewed, the licence may be struck off the register and visas may be cancelled or marked absconding. Amendments cannot be made on an expired licence. The official IFZA article says a grace period exists but does not give its length, and says portals are blocked once it ends. No official day thresholds found (unknown). Consultancies claim a 30-day grace period or no grace period at all; they conflict.
Notes	Only the consequences and the financial-statements requirement come from IFZA's own sources. The lease rule, the renewal window and all day thresholds are unknown. IFZA sits in Dubai Silicon Oasis. DIEZA regulations may apply to IFZA companies, but this was not verified.
Sources	ifza.com/wp-content/uploads/2024/03/how-to-renew-your-genera · cdn.ifza.com/marketing/FAQs%20Update_.pdf · ifza.com/en/missed-trade-license-renewal-uae/

Innovation City (Ras Al Khaimah)

confirmed

Lease at renewal unknown

When to renew unknown

Renews together unknown

If late Innovation City Companies Regulations (policy/rules-and-regulations page), regulation 135(1)(B)(i): the Registrar may strike off a company that does not pay its annual renewal fee or late payment fine by the due date. Under 135(4), the Registrar sends notice that the company's status will change to inactive six months after the payment due date. The company will be struck off six months after the due date unless all outstanding payments are received, with a website notice for at least 7 days. Strike-off takes effect from the date of the website notice (135(7)). A company that stays struck off for three continuous years is considered dissolved (reg 137). Restoration is possible before dissolution on payment of fees and fines (reg 138). Failure to renew the licence is also listed as a ground for winding up.

Notes The regulation gives six months for both 'inactive' and struck off, measured from the renewal fee due date. That is the text as published. No lease, renewal window or workspace rules found on the policy hub or terms and conditions pages.

Sources innovationcity.com/policy · innovationcity.com/policy/rules-and-regulations · innovationcity.com/policy/guidance · innovationcity.com/policy/terms-conditions

Jebel Ali Free Zone (JAFZA)

confirmed

Lease at renewal No minimum number of days found. The official Lease Renewal guide says the Lease must be valid to renew the company's Jafza licence. For a 3-year licence renewal, the plot or sublease must have more than 3 years of validity, with 3 years' rent paid.

When to renew The official Renew License guide says a trade licence can be renewed within three months before expiry.

Renews together The lease has to be valid, and it is renewed through its own service request, which the system creates automatically when the lease is due. Companies with a plot or sublease can renew the licence and lease for 3 years. Establishment card: unknown.

If late The official guides say a fine is charged for renewing an already expired licence, plus a monthly fine while it stays expired, including when terminating an expired licence. No official grace period or suspension/termination day threshold found (unknown).

Notes Consultancies mention suspension, frozen visa transactions and blacklisting after a long lapse. No official source found for these.

Sources www.jafza.ae/resource-centre/guides/renew-license/ · www.jafza.ae/resource-centre/guides/lease-renewal/ · www.jafza.ae/resource-centre/guides/terminating-your-license

Khalifa Economic Zones Abu Dhabi (KEZAD)

confirmed

Lease at renewal	No minimum remaining term stated. ADFZ Business Licensing Regulations (Dec 2011, published on kezadgroup.com), clause 4.2: licences are not issued to licensees without a valid Tenure Document (lease, musataha or similar). Clause 13.2(iv): breach of or default under the Tenure Document is a ground for revoking or suspending the licence. No 90-day rule found.
When to renew	Clause 9.4 of the ADFZ Business Licensing Regulations (Dec 2011): the renewal application must be made to ADPC no later than three (3) months before the end of the current licence term. All fees must be paid before renewal (9.5). Renewal is normally for one year (9.7).
Renews together	A valid Tenure Document (lease) is required for a licence (clause 4.2), and other documents are required under ADPC instruments (9.6). Nothing found officially on the establishment card or insurance renewing together. The KEZAD Standard Lease Terms (2026) require the tenant to insure throughout the term.
If late	No grace period or day threshold found. ADPC may revoke or suspend a licence by written notice if a renewal fee, late fee or fine is unpaid (clause 13.2(iii)). Suspension lasts for a period ADPC specifies or until conditions are met (13.3). No automatic deregistration timing found.
Notes	The regulations date from 2011, when the zone was Abu Dhabi Free Zone and ADPC was the licensing body. Current practice may differ. The 3-month renewal application deadline is the only explicit timing rule found.
Sources	www.kezadgroup.com/business-setup/regulations/ · www.kezadgroup.com/wp-content/uploads/sites/23/2026/04/ADFZ- · www.kezadgroup.com/wp-content/uploads/sites/23/2026/09/KEZAD · www.kezadgroup.com/en/business-facilities/free-zone

Masdar City Free Zone

reported

Lease at renewal	unknown. Consultancy sources (search summaries only) say each licence must be linked to a valid office lease in the free zone. No minimum remaining term found.
When to renew	unknown as an official rule. A blog post on masdarcityfreezone.com , written as general Abu Dhabi guidance, recommends preparing renewal documents 30 to 45 days before expiry.
Renews together	unknown
If late	unknown. The Masdar blog says only that an expired licence leaves the company not fully active until renewed, which can cause administrative, visa and banking problems. No grace period, suspension or deregistration thresholds were found.
Notes	The Masdar legal and regulation page lists only federal cabinet decisions, not zone licensing regulations. No official renewal rules were found.
Sources	masdarcityfreezone.com/resources/blog/abu-dhabi-free-zone-li · masdarcityfreezone.com/explore/legal-and-regulation · masdarcityfreezone.com/explore/license-and-registration

Meydan Free Zone

confirmed

Lease at renewal	unknown. Meydan's own blog says no Ejari or NOC is needed at renewal because Meydan handles the lease internally. No minimum remaining period found.
When to renew	unknown from an official source. Consultancies say Meydan sends a reminder 30 days before expiry. A 90-day advance notification is reported for Virtual Asset licences only.
Renews together	Meydan's blog says visa allocations can be renewed or added, and activities changed, during licence renewal. Meydan's Terms say the visa allocation fee runs for one year alongside the business licence expiry. Establishment or immigration card renewal timing: unknown.
If late	Meydan's official blog says there is a 30-day grace period after expiry, with penalties still applying. It says long delays can lead to licence cancellation or blacklisting. Meydan's Terms say that on non-renewal the Free Zone may cancel all linked services, including immigration cards, employment contracts and visas. They also allow all services and licences to be suspended for overdue invoices. No official day threshold for cancellation found.
Notes	The grace period and the consequences come from meydanzfz.ae (blog and Terms and Conditions). The lease rule and the renewal window are unknown.
Sources	www.meydanzfz.ae/blog/dubai-trade-license-renewal-guide · www.meydanzfz.ae/terms-conditions

National Industries Park

confirmed

Lease at renewal	Official NIP Rules 2024: a customer must hold a valid Lease and a valid License to operate (Rule 6.2). To qualify for and keep a License, it must hold a valid Lease in NIP (Rule 7.2(a)). Workstation customers may have different requirements. No minimum remaining lease period is stated.
When to renew	unknown. Rule 6.3 says the Lease and License must be renewed within the time frame set by National Industries Park, but no number of days is given.
Renews together	Official: Lease and License are renewed together (Rule 6.3). Renewal conditions (Rule 7.3) are listed below. A valid Fitness Certificate for the premises, except NIP-provided offices and workstations. A commitment to submit audited annual financials. A valid registration or good standing certificate from the place of incorporation. All dues paid, plus any other requirement NIP sets. Third-party liability and workmen's compensation insurance copies must be provided as renewed annually (Rule 10.2.4).
If late	Partly official. The tariff has a licence late payment fee. On termination or invalidity of the Lease or License, the customer must settle dues, cancel or transfer sponsored employees, and vacate the premises (Rule 19). No grace period or day threshold for suspension or cancellation after expiry was found.
Notes	NIP Rules and Regulations 2024 Edition, issued under Law No. 4 of 2003 and signed by the PCFC Chairman. NIP is part of DP World UAE. Its business-setup page also refers to the Dubai Unified License, so check whether a given company holds an NIP licence or a mainland licence. Jafza's three-month renewal window is not confirmed to apply to NIP.
Sources	nip.ae/ · nip.ae/business-setup/ · www.nip.ae/download/1101/

Ras Al Khaimah Economic Zone (RAKEZ)

confirmed

Lease at renewal	No minimum remaining term found. Official RAKEZ Free Zone Licence Renewal Checklist (Issue 04, 22 Jan 2025): for physical facilities (office, warehouse, land), two copies of the renewed lease agreement signed by the authorised signatory must be submitted. The RAKEZ Violations Code (item 106) treats using a facility without a valid licence or valid lease as a violation. The consequences are a warning to renew within 5 working days, then a second warning within 3 working days with suspension or partial block of the facility.
When to renew	Renew on or before the expiry date. No earliest renewal date stated. The checklist says some amendment requests at renewal (activity or licence type change, adding or cancelling a licence, lease upgrade or downgrade) are only accepted 60 days before licence expiry.
Renews together	Renewed lease agreement (for physical facilities), Chamber of Commerce membership renewal (if any), Immigration File e-card (issued with the renewed licence per the RAKEZ renewal FAQ), E-Channel registration or renewal for immigration services, and regulator NOCs where applicable.
If late	No grace period after expiry (official RAKEZ renewal FAQ). A daily late penalty runs from the expiry date. Under the RAKEZ Violations Code, sponsored visas are marked absconded on the 30th day after licence expiry. The company and its owners are marked absconded on the 30th day. The company's registration records and all licences are struck off after 6 months from licence expiry.
Notes	All key thresholds (30 days, 6 months, no grace) come from RAKEZ official documents. The Violations Code PDF shows no issue date in the extracted text.
Sources	renewalsupport.rakez.com/ · rakez.com/Upload/ManageDocument/Checklist-Licence-Renewal-Fr · rakez.com/Upload/ManageDocument/VIOLATIONS-CODE_202004081423 · rakez.com/en/customer-services/licensing-renewals

Sharjah Airport International Free Zone (SAIF Zone)

confirmed

Lease at renewal	unknown
When to renew	unknown
Renews together	Official 'Application for Lease & License Renewal' (SAIF Zone/LLL/Feb 2019): lease and licence are renewed together in one application and paid on one renewal invoice. The P.O. Box renewal receipt is also required. Other items: audited financial statements (FZE/FZC), certificate of good standing (branches), sector approvals, and building and safety certificates for land tenants. The form asks the applicant to have signed and collected the tenancy contract.
If late	unknown. The official FAQ says only that a cancelled company can be restored by paying the required amounts. No grace period or day thresholds are stated.
Notes	Only the combined lease and licence renewal is confirmed. Official FAQ: facilities are on long-term leases, renewable, with yearly payment. No 90-day lease rule found.
Sources	www.saif-zone.com/media/g4jdbl4i/renewal_form.pdf · www.saif-zone.com/en/faq/

Sharjah Media City (Shams)

confirmed

Lease at renewal	unknown
When to renew	Official Companies and Licensing Regulations 2017, art. 12.1: the licence must be renewed before the current term expires. No earlier window (for example X days before) is stated in an official source. Consultancies suggest starting 30 to 45 days before expiry (reported only).
Renews together	Official terms (shamsfz.ae, which shams.ae links to): visa allocations must be renewed together with the business licence at licence renewal. Lease or flexi desk renewal: unknown from an official source. Consultancies say an updated lease is needed (reported).
If late	Official terms (shamsfz.ae): 30-day grace period from licence expiry, then a monthly late penalty accrues until the licence is renewed or cancelled. The Authority may issue a legal notice 6 months after expiry, suspend the company at 7 months after expiry, and cancel the immigration card and visas. The 2017 Regulations, art. 13.2, also let the Authority suspend or cancel for unpaid renewal fees, with written notice.
Notes	shams.ae is the Sharjah Media City site and links to shamsfz.ae. A fetch reported that shamsfz.ae is run by Shams Customer Servicing LLC as Sharjah Media City (Shams). The grace, legal notice and suspension thresholds come from those terms. Renewal before expiry comes from the 2017 Regulations PDF on shams.ae. No 90-day lease rule found.
Sources	www.shams.ae/hubfs/Regulations%2020250429/Regulations/Shams%2020250429/Regulations/Shams%2020250429.pdf · shamsfz.ae/terms-and-conditions/ · www.shams.ae/terms-and-conditions/ · www.shams.ae/knowledge-center/faqs/ · shamsfz.ae/knowledge-hub/faqs/ · www.shams.ae/ · nowconsultant.com/shams-license-renewal/

SPC Free Zone (Sharjah Publishing City)

reported

Lease at renewal	unknown
When to renew	unknown
Renews together	Reported only: renewal covers the licence and the office lease (consultancy, plus the SPC blog saying you sign the renewed lease agreement). KYC details must be confirmed at renewal (consultancy).
If late	SPC official FAQ: late renewal can lead to fines and possible suspension of business activities, with no day thresholds given. The SPC blog mentions a 30-day grace period after expiry, but it describes Dubai trade licences in general and does not state it as an SPC rule.
Notes	The 2016 SPC Licensing Regulations exist (Lexis Middle East) but the text was not accessible. The spcfz.ae rules page lists only AML and UBO documents. No SPC-specific day thresholds were confirmed. No 90-day lease rule found.
Sources	www.spcfz.ae/faqs/ · www.spcfz.ae/blogs/trade-license-renewal-in-dubai-uae/ · www.spcfz.ae/blog/s/all-you-need-to-know-about-free-zone-lice · spcfz.ae/rules-regulations-and-policies/ · www.lexismiddleeast.com/regulatory/Sharjah/SharjahFreezonePu

SRTIP / SPark (Sharjah Research, Technology and Innovation Park)

confirmed

Lease at renewal	unknown
When to renew	unknown
Renews together	Official 'Application for Lease & License Renewal' form: lease and licence are renewed together in one application for a stated period, subject to SRTIP approval. Documents include renewal payment proof, an attested certificate of good standing (branches), shareholder passports, and, for plot or shell-and-core tenants, a building completion certificate or building permit, safety fitness certificate and utility connection.
If late	unknown
Notes	Only the combined lease and licence renewal is confirmed, from the official form. The official site gives no grace period or deregistration thresholds. No 90-day lease rule found.
Sources	srtip.ae/wp-content/uploads/2025/09/Renewal-Application-form · srtip.ae/

twofour54

confirmed

Lease at renewal	No minimum remaining term found. Creative Media Authority Licensing Regulations 2016, clause 4.4.1: a company or branch licensee must maintain appropriate premises within the Zone at all times unless the Authority waives this. The CMA site also says an office in the Creative Zone is required.
When to renew	CMA Licensing Regulations 2016, clause 7.1: the licensee shall apply for renewal two (2) months before the licence expires, submitting the prescribed form, documents and fees.
Renews together	unknown for lease, establishment card and insurance. Clause 9.2 of the dissemination licence section says a Dissemination Licence is automatically suspended, revoked or terminated if the Business Licence is suspended, revoked or expires.
If late	No grace period or day thresholds found. The Authority may suspend or revoke a licence at its discretion by notice (clause 15.2), and may refuse renewal (7.4).
Notes	Regulator is the Creative Media Authority (formerly Media Zone Authority). The regulations are dated 2016 and may have been updated since.
Sources	www.cma.gov.ae/regulation-license · www.cma.gov.ae/storage/regulationMedias/95af9304-b8bc-4055-9 · twofour54.com/en/business-setup/frequently-asked-questions

Umm Al Quwain Free Trade Zone (UAQ FTZ)

confirmed

Lease at renewal	No minimum-remaining rule. Official Regulations (2015) 5.4 and 6.4(b): a valid lease is required to hold a licence. The official renewal checklist requires a 'Renewed Lease Agreement', and the renewed licence and lease agreement are issued together.
When to renew	Official Regulations 6.8: licences must be renewed no later than 30 days before the current licence's expiry date.
Renews together	Official checklist and form: renewed lease agreement (issued with the renewed licence), UBO declaration and UBO passports, insurance copy for warehouse or land, civil defence certificate for industrial licences. Regulations 10.6: the Operation Fitness Certificate must be renewed annually before licence renewal. Regulations 6.9: no arrears of rent, levies or fines.
If late	Official Regulations 6.8: failure to renew on time attracts a fine and may lead to permanent revocation, refusal of renewal and/or de-registration. 6.15: licences will not be renewed after 6 months from the expiry date, and facilities are repossessed when the lease expires unrenewed. 7.2(f): the licence can be revoked on written notice if renewal documents are not submitted. 14.10: sponsorship of employees can be terminated if the licence or lease is not renewed. The checklist note says late fees apply if not renewed by the expiry date.
Notes	First edition of the Regulations (March 2015), still the one linked on the downloads page. No 90-day lease rule. The 30-day figure is a deadline to renew before licence expiry, not a lease-remaining rule.
Sources	uaqftz.gov.ae/gallery/Freezone_rules_and_regulations.pdf · uaqftz.gov.ae/gallery/UAQ-FTZ-License-Renewal-Required-Docum · uaqftz.gov.ae/gallery/UAQ-FTZ-License-Renewal-Application-Fo · uaqftz.gov.ae/downloads · uaqftz.gov.ae/ · uaqftz.gov.ae/licensing-services